

European service-hub expansion

Meridian Parts | Board decision paper | 27 September 2026

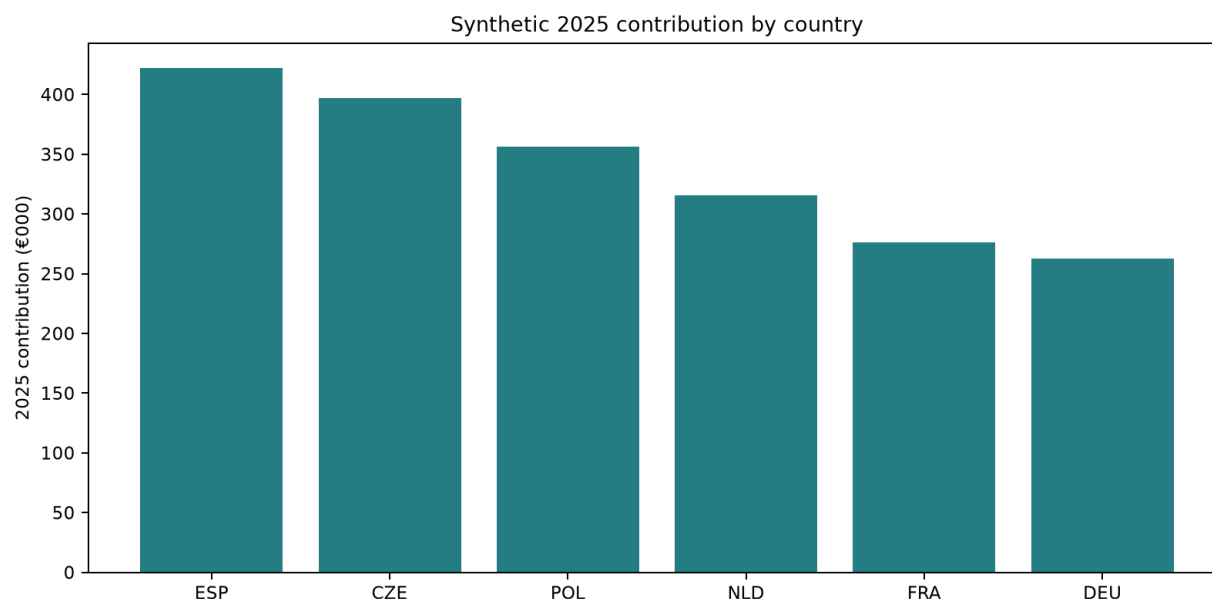
Recommendation

Advance Czechia + Spain as a gated case: €225,000 capex, 5 FTE, €198,099/year base increment, €64,619 low, €32,180 stress, 1.14-year simple payback. The strongest alternative is POL + ESP (€186,329/year base). Validate before irreversible commitment.

2025 synthetic operating baseline

Orders	Units	Gross	Refunds	Net sales	Net COGS	Fulfillment	Contribution	Margin
1,254	77,436	€4,464,622	€80,831	€4,383,792	€2,246,919	€106,862	€2,030,010	46.3%

Booked revenue is shipments less credits; cash timing is absent. Contribution also deducts net COGS and fulfillment.



Portfolio economics

Portfolio	Capex	FTE	Low	Base	High	Stress	Payback
CZE+ESP	€225,000	5	€64,619	€198,099	€331,580	€32,180	1.14y
POL+ESP	€240,000	6	€58,562	€186,329	€314,096	€29,264	1.29y
POL+CZE	€205,000	5	€56,856	€178,995	€301,134	€-78,570	1.15y
NLD+ESP	€270,000	6	€43,994	€166,931	€289,869	€107,630	1.62y
NLD+CZE	€235,000	5	€42,289	€159,598	€276,907	€-203	1.47y
NLD+POL	€250,000	6	€36,232	€147,828	€259,423	€-3,119	1.69y
FRA+ESP	€340,000	7	€13,687	€129,849	€246,012	€73,105	2.62y
FRA+CZE	€305,000	6	€11,981	€122,516	€233,050	€-34,729	2.49y

90-day implementation and gates

Days 0–30 | CFO + Commercial Operations: join orders, credits, carrier lanes, cost and returns; review invoice samples. Gate 1: $\geq 98\%$ record and cost coverage, FX and cutoff reviewed, Finance signs baseline. Dependency: operational-system access.

Days 31–60 | COO + Regional Service: validate catchment, addressable units, avoidable lane savings and delivery baseline; obtain lease, labor, carrier and fit-out quotes; design reversible pilot. Gate 2: economics remain positive in low volume and joint stress, within €450k and seven FTE.

Days 61–90 | CEO/Board sponsor + CFO: stage release after named owner, SLA, inventory controls and signed costs. Gate 3: approve pilot/fit-out only if evidence passes; otherwise defer with dated review.

Market context: World Bank population changed Spain +2.22%, Czechia +2.18%, Poland -0.71% from 2022–24. 2024 GDP/capita was \$67,465 in Netherlands and \$25,104 in Poland (current US\$); context only, not demand proof.

Weekly KPI: OTIF vs baseline, delivery hours, expedite EUR/order, return rate/restock recovery, fill rate, eligible units, contribution after recurring hub cost, capex forecast and FTE. Owners: Service, Supply Chain, Commercial Ops, Finance and HR. Risks include synthetic assumption transferability, quote inflation, stock obsolescence, delayed recovery, FX and ramp.

Evidence, accounting and limitations

Resolve highest revisions, include shipped non-test 2025 orders including free shipments, attach returns only through 2026-01-31 and quarantine unlinked IDs. Sale month ECB mean is local units per EUR; per-order components half-up to cents. Restocked units recover cost. Quality: 1328 order rows, 13 duplicate rows, 1254 eligible; 241 return IDs attached, 1 quarantined. All 72 month-country rows reconcile. Client data/options are synthetic. Frozen official-source data: ECB and World Bank; WB lastupdated 2026-07-13, captured 2026-09-27. Missing values not imputed. Scenarios are assumption-driven, non-causal and undiscounted. No interviews or live account access. See source-register.csv and evidence/raw for source trail.